actually carve out more room for India to pursue the strategic autonomy it values.

Indian policymakers' fixation with non-alignment has remained a central component of Indian identity in global politics. Modi, with his centre-right political inclinations, does not share an ideological attachment to Nehru's ideas. In fact, he has gradually, but decisively, shifted Indian foreign policy in directions which few would have dared try before. While sections of the Indian intellectual establishment still retain reflexive anti-Americanism, Modi has used his decisive mandate to carve a new partnership with the United States to harness its capital and technology for his domestic development agenda. He is not ambivalent about positioning India as a challenger to China's growing regional might and assertiveness. With this broader strategic picture in mind, he signed the bilateral "Logistics Exchange Memorandum of Agreement" with the United States for facilitating logistical support, supplies, and services between the US and Indian militaries on a reimbursable basis and providing a framework to govern such exchanges.

India's rising global profile is reshaping New Delhi's approach to its major partnerships in the changing global order. Though it may not be quick to drop its attachment to non-alignment in theory, New Delhi is showing signs of pursuing strategic autonomy separately from non-alignment under Narendra Modi. Under the Modi government, India is charting new territory in its foreign policy, predicated on the belief that, rather than proclaiming non-alignment as an end in itself, India needs deeper engagement with its friends and partners if it is to develop leverage in its dealings with its adversaries and competitors. India is today well positioned to define its bilateral relationships on its own terms and would do well to continue engaging more closely with those countries that can facilitate its rise to regional and global prominence. This re-think on non-alignment is important to